

Almost all of a degradation's damage travels through the transcript

Imai, Keele & Tingley (2010) potential-outcomes decomposition; total = ACME + ADE holds exactly. 23,712 rows, 416 utterances, one clean-vs-degradation contrast per cell. Whiskers are the cluster bootstrap 95% interval on each component (B = 100, --sim 800, --boot-sim 100, seed 42). The mediated path excludes zero in 14 of 18 cells; the direct path in 2, marked * — reverberation at 10 dB and at 0 dB, and nowhere else. The point estimates grow with severity throughout, but that is a statement about point estimates only.

